

yumeng ma

HUMAN-AI INTERACTION ACCESSIBLE COMPUTING SYSTEM DESIGN & EVALUATION

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Education

University of Washington

Seattle, WA

PHD IN COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING

2024 - Present

GPA: 4.0 / 4.0

Advisor: Jacob O. Wobbrock

Brown University

Providence, RI

SC.M IN COMPUTER SCIENCE

2022 - 2024

GPA: 4.0 / 4.0

Advisor: Jeff Huang

Arizona State University

Tempe, AZ

B.S. IN COMPUTER SCIENCE AND PSYCHOLOGY

2019 - 2022

Barrett Honors College

GPA: 4.0 / 4.0 Summa Cum Laude

Thesis: "Assessing Exhibit Interaction through Bridging the Connections Between Biometrics and Traditional Tools"

Publications

* denotes equal contribution

CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

Yumeng Ma, Alexis Hiniker, and Jacob O. Wobbrock. 2026. Quantifying the Novelty Bias When Evaluating Interactive Prototypes. In *Proceedings of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '26)*.

🏆 **Best Paper Honorable Mention Award**

paper

Zainab Iftikhar, **Yumeng Ma**, and Jeff Huang. 2023. "Together but not together": Evaluating Typing Indicators for Interaction-Rich Communication. In *Proceedings of the 2023 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '23)*.

paper

Ian Gonsher, **Yumeng Ma**, Ivan Pineda-Dominguez, Matthew Lee, and Yuxin Han. 2023. The Mixed Reality Passthrough Window: Rethinking the Laptop Videoconferencing Experience. *Human Interaction and Emerging Technologies (IHET-AI 2023): Artificial Intelligence and Future Applications*.

paper

SHORT PAPERS & EXTENDED ABSTRACTS

Yumeng Ma* and Jiahao Ren*. 2023. ProactiveAgent: Personalized Context-Aware Reminder System. In *The 36th Annual ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (UIST '23 Adjunct)*.

paper

Research Experience

UW ACE Lab

Seattle, WA

GRADUATE RESEARCH ASSISTANT, ADVISED BY PROF. JACOB WOB BROCK

2024 - Present

- Currently collaborating with Microsoft on benchmarking AI-generated code to identify accessibility gaps and improve its reliability for inclusive web development.

Brown Department of Neuroscience

Providence, RI

COMPUTER VISION RESEARCH ASSISTANT, ADVISED BY PROF. MICHAEL PARADISO

2023 - 2024

- Built a visual prosthesis system for blind and low vision users to locate everyday objects and identify surrounding text.

UCLA HCI Lab

Los Angeles, CA

HCI RESEARCH INTERN, ADVISED BY PROF. XIANG 'ANTHONY' CHEN

Summer 2023

- Led the development of a proactive reminder system that takes in user context, history, and spoken interactions by leveraging LLMs and personal agents.

Brown Department of Engineering

Providence, RI

DESIGN RESEARCH ASSISTANT, ADVISED BY PROF. IAN GONSHER

2022 - 2023

- Introduced a new paradigm for the integration of AR into laptop and desktop displays to enable local users to interact more easily and seamlessly with remote users during videoconferencing sessions.

Brown HCI Lab

Providence, RI

DISTRIBUTED RESEARCH EXPERIENCES FOR UNDERGRADUATES, ADVISED BY PROF. JEFF HUANG

Summer 2022

- Designed novel typing indicators and found that they enhance user co-presence in written communication through mixed method analysis.

ASU SoLET Lab

Tempe, AZ

PSYCHOLOGY RESEARCH ASSISTANT, ADVISED BY DR. DANIELLE MCNAMARA

2022

- Conducted testing and evaluation of tutoring systems to optimize learning and educational practices for underrepresented groups.

NASA Psyche Mission

Tempe, AZ

HCI RESEARCH ASSISTANT, ADVISED BY PROF. MARIA ELENA CHAVEZ ECHEAGARAY

2021 - 2022

- Developed a web app that allows users to interact with the Psyche Spacecraft model and led user studies with biometric data analysis that showed the app increased public engagement.

Work Experience

Infosys

RESEARCH SCIENTIST INTERN, APPLIED RESEARCH CENTER FOR AUTONOMOUS MACHINES TEAM

Summer 2025

- Conducted design research on autonomous vehicle interfaces and created graceful degradation strategies using multimodal hazard escalation storyboards and user studies.

Infosys

UX DESIGN INTERN, LIVING LABS TEAM

Summer 2024

- Spearheaded the design of an accessible phygital UI that integrate emerging AI trends to optimize retail experiences for diverse user personas.

Brown + NASA

Providence, RI

MOBILE DEVELOPER

2023 - 2024

- Led and developed a sound and haptic-enabled cross-platform mobile app to help blind and low vision individuals explore and learn about space.

Civillience

PROJECT MANAGEMENT & UX DESIGN INTERN | LIAISON BETWEEN FRONTEND AND UIUX

2023

- Led the UI/UX team to design a web-based app with interactive health data visualizations and built reusable components for a consistent design system across the product

Awards, Fellowships, & Grants

2025 **Microsoft Research Grant**, Microsoft & CREATE at UW

2024 **NSF Graduate Research Fellowship**, NSF

2024 **Paul G. Allen School Fellowship**, UW

2019 - 2023 **Microsoft DisAbility Scholarship**, Microsoft

Invited Talks

2026 **Panelist**, Microsoft Ability Summit

Redmond, WA

2025 **Lightning Round Speaker**, Open Source Accessibility Summit

Raleigh, NC

Teaching

Spring '26 **CSE 440 Human-computer Interaction**, Graduate TA for Amy Zhang, UW
Winter '26 **CSE 443 Digital Accessibility**, Graduate TA for Jennifer Mankoff, UW
Spring '22 **CSE 365 Information Assurance**, TA for Adam Doupe and Tiffany Bao, ASU

Service & Professional Activities

2026	Reviewer , UIST	
2022 - 2024	Master's Representative , Brown University CS Diversity Committee	<i>Providence, RI</i>
2023	Student Volunteer , UIST	<i>San Francisco, CA</i>
2022	Google CS Research Mentorship Program Fellow , Google	
2020 - 2021	Microsoft Support / Xbox Advocate , Microsoft	<i>Tempe, AZ</i>